

90-DAY SOFTWARE TESTING CAREER ROADMAP

Risk Assessment Matrix

Prioritise testing by rating likelihood against impact.

Introduction

A risk assessment matrix helps you focus testing where it matters by rating each risk on likelihood (how probable) and impact (how damaging). High-likelihood, high-impact risks get the deepest testing.

Instructions

- List the risks for the feature or release.
- Rate each: Likelihood (Low/Medium/High) and Impact (Low/Medium/High).
- Combine to a rating and focus effort on the highest.

The Matrix

Likelihood \ Impact	Low	Medium	High
High	Medium	High	Critical
Medium	Low	Medium	High
Low	Low	Low	Medium

Real QA Example

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Rating
Payment double-charge	Medium	High	High
Minor label misalignment	High	Low	Medium
Data loss on save	Low	High	Medium

Blank Reusable Template

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Rating	Test focus
	L/M/H	L/M/H		

Best Practice Tips

- Rate with the team and stakeholders — risk is a shared judgement.
- Re-assess as the product and context change.
- Use the ratings to justify where you spend testing time.

Common Mistakes

- Rating everything "high".
- Assessing once and never revisiting.
- Not linking the rating to actual test effort.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

A risk matrix turns "I tested a lot" into "I focused on the biggest risks, and here is why" — exactly the judgement employers pay for.